Cracking a hashed password

How can an attacker recover a password from its stored hash? (From easier to harder)

- **Rainbow table attack:** use precomputed hash tables to recover passwords from unsalted hashes
- **Password-list attack:** try common, weak, or previously leaked passwords
- **Dictionary attack:** generate password candidates from words, names, dates, and predictable variations
- **Brute-force attack:** systematically try all possible character combinations until a match is found

Tools: John the Ripper, HashCat

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Millions of LinkedIn passwords reportedly leaked online

A hacker says he's posted 6.5 million LinkedIn passwords on the Web -- hot on the heels of security researchers' warnings about privacy issues with LinkedIn's iOS app.



by Lance Whitney | June 6, 2012 6:31 AM PD

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Update 1:08 p.m. PT: *LinkedIn confirms that passwords were "compromised."*

LinkedIn users could be facing yet another security problem.

A user in a Russian forum says that he has hacked and uploaded almost 6.5 million LinkedIn passwords, according to The Verge. Though his claim has yet to be confirmed, Twitter users are already reporting that they've found their hashed LinkedIn passwords on the list, security expert Per Thorsheim said.

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Hackers post 450K credentials pilfered from Yahoo

Credentials posted in plain text appear to have originated from the Web company's Yahoo Voices platform. The hackers say they intended the data dump as a "wake-up call."



by Steven Musil | July 11, 2012 11:06 PM PDT

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Yahoo has been the victim of a security breach that yielded hundreds of thousands of login credentials stored in plain text.

The hacked data, posted to the hacker site D33D Company, contained more than 453,000 login credentials and appears to have originated from the Web pioneer's network. The hackers, who said they used a union-based SQL injection technique to penetrate the Yahoo subdomain, intended the data dump to be a "wake-up call."